

EMPLOYEE ACCESS · VERSION 1.0

How to sign in to the research desk

A step-by-step guide to reaching the Hey Jamie trading desk. Read it once end to end before your first sign-in — three of the five steps happen only once, and one of them produces codes you cannot get back if you lose them.

WHAT	WHERE
The desk	https://valor-desk.tail53cfa4.ts.net
Sign-in page on the website	https://valorftc.ai → Employee sign-in
Network required	Tailscale (company VPN) — the desk is unreachable without it
What you need	Username · password · 6-digit authenticator code

Before you start

Steps 1–3 need an administrator. Ask for them together in one message — a Tailscale invite **and** a desk account — so you are not waiting twice.

OVERVIEW

The five steps

#	STEP	HOW OFTEN
01	Get on the company network (Tailscale)	Once per device
02	Get your desk account from an admin	Once
03	Set up your authenticator + save recovery codes	Once
04	Open the desk and sign in	Every time
05	Sign out when you are done	Every time

PART ONE

First-time setup

You do this once. After it is done, signing in takes about ten seconds and you never repeat any of this.

STEP 01

Get on the company network

The desk is not on the public internet. It sits on the company's private Tailscale network, so a stranger cannot even find it, let alone try a password. Your device has to join that network first.

What to do

- Ask an administrator to send you a **Tailscale invite**. It arrives by email.
- Open the invite and accept it. You will sign in with your work account.
- Install Tailscale on the device you will use: `tailscale.com/download` — it is available for macOS, Windows, iPhone, iPad, Android and Linux.
- Open the app and confirm it says **Connected**.

How to know it worked

The Tailscale icon shows as connected, and the machine list includes a device named `valor-desk`. That is the desk. If you do not see it, you are not on the network yet — the rest of this guide will not work until you are.

STEP 02

Get your desk account

Accounts are created by an administrator at a terminal. There is no self-service sign-up, and there is no way to request an account from the login page — this is deliberate.

What to do

- Ask an administrator to create your account. They will tell you your **username** (usually your first name, all lowercase).
- **You type your own password**, at their keyboard or over a screen share — it is never emailed, never sent in chat, and never written down. It must be at least **12 characters**.
- Choose a passphrase, not a password. Four unrelated words beats a short string of symbols, and you will actually remember it.

Nobody can recover your password — not even an administrator

The system never stores your password. It stores only a one-way verifier that can check a password but cannot reveal one. If you forget it, an admin can set a new one; they cannot tell you the old one.

STEP 03

Set up your authenticator and save your recovery codes

A password alone is not enough to get in. You also need a 6-digit code that changes every 30 seconds, generated by an app on your phone. This is the layer that protects you if your password ever leaks.

What to do

- Install an authenticator app if you do not have one: **1Password**, **Authy**, **Google Authenticator**, or your phone's built-in password manager all work.
- When the administrator enrolls you, the screen shows a **secret** and a QR code. Scan the QR code with your authenticator app, or type the secret in by hand.
- The same screen prints **10 recovery codes**. Save them somewhere safe and private — a password manager is ideal, a photo in your camera roll is not.
- Ask the admin to run the verification step, which checks your app is generating the right codes before you depend on it.

The recovery codes are shown exactly once

They cannot be displayed again, and nobody can look them up. Each one works a single time and then burns itself. They are what gets you in if your phone is lost, stolen, or wiped — so save them before you close that screen.

PART TWO

Signing in, every time

Once setup is done, this is the whole routine. It takes about ten seconds.

STEP 04

Open the desk and sign in

4.1 — Check you are on the network

Open Tailscale and confirm it says **Connected**. This is the single most common reason the page will not load, and checking takes two seconds.

4.2 — Open the desk

Either route works. Both land in the same place:

- **From the website:** go to <https://valorftc.ai>, click **Employee sign-in** in the top bar, then **Go to the desk**.
- **Direct:** go straight to <https://valor-desk.tail53cfa4.ts.net>. Bookmark this one — it is faster.

You should see a padlock

The desk has a real certificate, so your browser shows a normal secure padlock with no warnings. **If your browser warns you that the connection is not private, stop and tell an administrator.** On this network you should never have to click through a certificate warning.

4.3 — Enter your username and password

The page shows the Hey Jamie sign-in card with two boxes. Type your username (all lowercase) and your password, then press **Sign in**.

4.4 — Enter your authenticator code

The card then asks for your 6-digit code. Open your authenticator app, read the current code for Hey Jamie, type it in, and press **Verify**.

- Codes change every 30 seconds. If yours is about to roll over, wait for the fresh one rather than racing it.
- Each code works **once**. If you mistype and retype the same code, it will be refused — wait for the next one.

- A **recovery code** can be typed into this same box if you do not have your phone. It works once and is then gone.

4.5 — You are in

You land directly in the Hey Jamie desk: strategies, backtests, walk-forward validation, paper sessions and the dashboard. What you can do there depends on the role your administrator gave you.

What each role can do

ROLE	CAN DO
viewer	Read the desk, past runs and dashboards.
researcher	Everything above, plus start backtests, walk-forward validation and paper sessions, and write research notes.
trader	Everything above. Reserved for a future live path; today it grants nothing extra.
admin	Everything above, plus managing accounts and shutting the desk down.

Signing in does not move money

The desk runs research and paper trading only. Live order routing is blocked in the code itself — not by a setting, not by a permission, and not by your role. No account on this system can place a real trade.

STEP 05

Sign out when you are done

On a shared or portable machine, sign out rather than just closing the tab. Your session also ends on its own:

- after **60 minutes** of no activity, and
- after **12 hours** no matter how active you have been.

When either happens you are returned to the sign-in page and simply sign in again.

PART THREE

When something goes wrong

Find your symptom in the left column. These cover very nearly everything people actually hit.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS AND WHAT TO DO
The page will not load at all	You are almost certainly not on the network. Open Tailscale and confirm it says Connected , then reload. If it is connected and the page still fails, check the address is exactly right, then tell an administrator — the desk may be stopped.
“That username and password did not match.”	Deliberately vague: it will not tell you which half was wrong, because that would let a stranger discover which usernames exist. Check caps lock, check your username is all lowercase, and try again.
“Too many attempts. Try again later.”	After 5 failed attempts the account locks for 15 minutes . Nothing is broken and nothing is lost. Wait it out — an administrator cannot shorten it — then try again carefully.
The code is refused, but it looks right	Three usual causes. (1) You reused a code that was already accepted — wait for the next one. (2) Your phone's clock has drifted; turn on automatic date and time. (3) You are reading the code for a different account in your authenticator.
I lost my phone	Use one of your recovery codes in the code box — it works once. Then tell an administrator immediately so they can re-enrol you on your new device and retire the old one.
I lost my recovery codes too	Tell an administrator. They will re-enrol your second factor, which issues a fresh secret and a fresh set of codes and invalidates the old ones.
I forgot my password	Ask an administrator to reset it. You will set the new one yourself. Resetting also signs out every other session on your account.
Signed out unexpectedly	Normal. Sessions end after 60 minutes idle or 12 hours total. Just sign in again.
Browser warns the connection is not private	Do not click through it. The desk has a real certificate, so this should never happen. Stop and report it to an administrator.
“Your role cannot do that.”	You tried something above your role — for example a viewer starting a backtest. Ask an administrator if you need a wider role.

Rules of the road

- **Never share your password or your codes.** Nobody at Valor FTC will ever ask you for either — not IT, not an administrator, not by email, not on a call. Any such request is an attack; report it.
- **Do not screenshot your recovery codes into a chat.** Put them in a password manager.
- **One person, one account.** Do not lend yours. Every action is written to an audit log against your name, and that log is what protects you if something is ever questioned.
- **Report a lost device the same day,** so your access can be revoked and re-issued.
- **Sign out on shared machines.** Closing the tab is not the same thing.

Three separate layers are protecting this desk

First, the network: a stranger cannot even reach the desk without being on the company's Tailscale network. Second, your password: stored only as a one-way verifier that is deliberately slow and memory-hard to attack. Third, your authenticator: a code that changes every 30 seconds and works only once. An attacker needs all three.

QUICK REFERENCE

Print this page and keep it

Every time you sign in

#	DO THIS
1	Open Tailscale. Confirm it says Connected .
2	Go to <code>https://valor-desk.tail53cfa4.ts.net</code>
3	Check for the padlock. No warnings.
4	Type your username (lowercase) and password. Press Sign in .
5	Type the 6-digit code from your authenticator. Press Verify .
6	Work. Sign out when you are done.

Numbers worth remembering

LIMIT	VALUE
Minimum password length	12 characters
Failed attempts before lockout	5
Lockout duration	15 minutes
Authenticator code length / refresh	6 digits / 30 seconds
Recovery codes issued	10 (each usable once)
Session ends after idle	60 minutes
Session ends regardless	12 hours

Who to ask

Anything you cannot resolve with Part Three goes to a Valor FTC administrator. Do not ask a colleague to sign in on your behalf, and do not use anyone else's account while you wait.